100 Days of Linux - Day 095

Title: Decision Making with if, elif and else

Today's Goal
Learn how to make decisions in Bash scripts using if, elif and else statements.

Why This Matters
Conditional statements allow scripts to react differently based on user input, files, arguments or command results.

Commands of the Day
Syntax:
if [condition]; then
commands
elif [condition]; then
commands
else
commands
fi

Beginner Lesson
The **if** statement checks whether a condition is true. If it is, Bash executes one block of commands. Otherwise it can check another condition with **elif** or execute the **else** block.

Practice Questions
1. Create a script named decision.sh.
2. Ask the user to enter a number.
3. Print 'Positive' if the number is greater than zero.
4. Print 'Zero' if the number equals zero.
5. Print 'Negative' if the number is less than zero.

Hints
Use **read** for input and numeric comparisons such as **-gt**, **-eq** and **-lt**.

Mini Challenge
Create a script that asks for a student's marks and prints Grade A, B, C or Fail using if, elif and else.

Common Mistakes
Forgetting **fi**, using incorrect comparison operators or missing spaces inside square brackets.

Did You Know?
Most automation scripts rely on conditional logic to handle different situations safely.

Pro Tip
Keep each condition simple and test your script with different inputs.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)
Q1: nano decision.sh
Q2: read NUMBER
Q3: if [$NUMBER -gt 0]
Q4: elif [$NUMBER -eq 0]
Q5: else ... fi

Homework
Write a script that asks for a person's age and prints whether they are a child, adult or senior.

Next Day Preview
Tomorrow you'll learn how to repeat tasks using for loops in Bash scripts.